

Detection Report: Local Account Manipulation & Deletion

Windows Endpoint | Wazuh SIEM Home Lab

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Detection #: 001

Detection Summary

A controlled account-lifecycle sequence was executed on a monitored Windows 10 endpoint (agent: **WindowsVM**, ID 001) to validate end-to-end detection through Wazuh SIEM. Windows Security events generated by the activity were ingested, decoded, and automatically mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques **T1098** (Account Manipulation), **T1531** (Account Access Removal), and **T1484** (Domain Policy Modification), with no manual tagging required.

Scenario & Trigger Actions

The sequence was designed to mirror both routine administrative activity and attacker persistence/cleanup behavior — creating an account, elevating its privileges, then removing evidence of the change. The following actions were performed in order on **WindowsVM**:

- Created a new local user account (**student1**)
- Added the account to the local **Administrators** group
- Removed the account from the local **Administrators** group
- Deleted the user account entirely

Investigation Process

After performing the actions, the Wazuh dashboard's **Discover** view was used to filter by Windows Security Event ID, tracing which events were generated, how they were decoded, and which rules fired against them.

Findings

Windows Event ID	Description	Rule ID	Rule Level	MITRE ATT&CK; Technique	MITRE Tactic(s)
4733	A member was removed from a security-enabled local group	60111	8	T1098 (Account Manipulation), T1531 (Account Access Removal)	Persistence, Impact
4726	A user account was deleted	60154	12	T1484 (Domain Policy Modification)	Defense Evasion, Privilege Escalation

Analysis

Severity escalation: Rule level rose from 8 (group membership change) to 12 (account deletion, with mail alerting flagged true). Wazuh's rule engine treats account deletion as materially higher-risk than a permission change, since deletion is harder to reverse and more consistent with cleanup / anti-forensic behavior.

Automatic MITRE mapping: Technique and tactic metadata were attached to each alert directly by Wazuh's decoder/rule set, derived automatically from the Windows Security event fields (`data.win.system.eventID`, `data.win.eventdata.*`) — no manual tagging was performed.

Audit trail integrity: Each event captured the subject/target user, SID, domain, and logon ID, providing a complete "who did what to whom" record sufficient to reconstruct the full action sequence from alert data alone, without referencing the endpoint directly.

MITRE ATT&CK Reference

MITRE ATT&CK is a publicly maintained knowledge base of real-world adversary tactics and techniques, built from observed intrusions rather than theoretical models. It organizes attacker behavior into:

Tactics — the attacker's goal (e.g., Persistence, Privilege Escalation, Defense Evasion)

Techniques — the specific method used to achieve that goal (e.g., manipulating an account, modifying domain policy)

This framework turns a raw alert into an answer to "what stage of an attack does this represent, and what could plausibly come next" — which is exactly what this exercise practiced at small scale, using a self-generated (rather than simulated/canned) alert chain.

Conclusion

This detection confirms that account-manipulation and account-deletion activity on the monitored Windows endpoint is reliably captured, correctly ruled, and automatically mapped to relevant MITRE ATT&CK techniques within Wazuh, validating the SIEM pipeline end-to-end for this attack pattern.